

THE FINEST HOUR

TEXT: Romans 8:28 “*And we know that all things work together for good to them that love God, to them who are the called according to his purpose.*”

INTRO: In 1940, bombs were falling all over Britain and fear gripped the hearts of the people. Prime Minister Winston Churchill stood and declared, “*This is our finest hour.*” (Can you imagine what people were thinking?)

This statement wasn’t made because the moment was easy — it was because they had the courage to rise to the challenge when everything seemed lost. (Today feels like one of those days to all of us – This has taken me by as much surprise as it has you – Pastor Shane has

assured me that the only reason this is happening today is because he and Debbie feel that they are being obedient to the voice of God)

The writer of Romans said “*All things work together for THE good...*”

God has a way of turning our most difficult moments into moments that launch Kingdom purpose forward. As difficult as this seems today, I am believing this will be one of those moments. I am believing it is going to be the finest hour for this church. I am believing it is going to be the finest hour for Shane and Debbie Williams!

I have learned that what often feels like defeat, often becomes moments that launch us into our destiny.

FINEST HOURS ARE BORN OUT OF EXTREME DIFFICULTY

The Apostle James said, “*Count it all joy when you encounter multiple times of testing...*”

Most of the time our greatest hour is initiated when everything seems to be falling apart. God forges champions in the fire, not in comfort. The finest oil comes from the most intense crushing.

Think of Joseph:

- Mishandled by his father...
- Betrayed by brothers...
- Sold as a slave...
- Falsely accused...
- Wrongfully sentenced...
- Unjustly imprisoned...

It was in the prison that God prepared him for the palace. The Scripture said that THEY ***“Placed his feet in shackles”*** – BUT - ***“GOD was molding a man for Egypt!”*** They put brass on his ankles, but God put iron in his soul!

What appeared to be Josephs worst hour became his finest hour! When he was shackled in a prison, God was plotting the rescue of two nations!

I am believing this moment of disappointment will actually turn out to be the finest hour for Morrilton Community Transformation Church and for the Williams family!

I am believing this test will become the birthplace of triumph!

FINEST HOURS CAN ONLY BE PRODUCED BY FAITH

What should one do when a difficult hour catches us by surprise? (This is one of those moments) Ephesians 6:13 “*Having done all, to stand - Stand.*”

Churchill’s finest hour came because he refused to give up and had faith enough to believe the outcome of the war was not yet decided.

Our finest hour will come when we stand by faith when we can’t see the final outcome. I have a word for community Transformation

Church today... *“Stand still and see the salvation of the Lord!”*

When Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego faced a fiery furnace, they stood by faith and God turned a death sentence into their finest hour!

Standing firm in faith doesn't mean you understand everything, it means you trust God when you do not understand. I must admit, I don't understand this moment, but I trust the Lord! *“Some trust in chariots and some trust in horses, but we trust in the name of the Lord!”*

Hey saints, don't flinch in this moment because your steadiness will be the very thing that enables you to be part of the story God is writing for tomorrow!

FINEST HOURS REVEAL KINGDOM PURPOSE

Jesus said of Lazarus death “*Lazarus is dead and I am glad...*” He was glad because they were about to see Him in a different light! John 11:4 “*This sickness is not unto death, but for the glory of God.*”

They knew him as:

- Friend...
- Rabbi...
- Teacher...
- Healer...
- Miracle worker...

Because of Lazarus death they were about to know Him in the power of resurrection! I am believing this moment is going to launch Community Transformation Church and the Williams family into an exponential moment of the glory of God!

When Lazarus died, it looked like all hope was lost. After Lazurs' resurrection Jesus said, ***“Did I not tell you that if you believe, you will see the glory of God?”*** Don't be the person that becomes distraught in the moment and finds yourself on the outside looking in on what God is about to do! I prophecy over Community transformation Church and the Williams family, ***“We will see the Glory of God!”***

When Jesus called Lazarus out of the tomb, what was once a moment of mourning became

the greatest miracle of Jesus to date! A moment of mourning became the finest hour.

The same God who turned death into life can turn sorrow into a song. Your current pain is setting the stage for a powerful display of His glory. That's a fact Jack!

CONCLUSION:

Winston Churchill's words weren't spoken in victory, but in defiance of defeat. Greatness is born in faith that refuses to surrender.

Ladies and Gentlemen, I prophecy that today will be looked back on as the finest hour for Community Transformation Church and the Williams family!